

comfort or to compensate for variations in eye spacing.

What are the requirements?

3-D glasses, 3-D content, Blu-ray player and supporting cables are required to enjoy 3-D TV. 3-D glasses are provided by the TV manufacturer and are proprietary of the specific brand. For instance, you can enjoy 3-D movies on Sony's 3-D TVs from glasses provided by Sony. Haier is providing two pairs of glasses free with its every 3-D TV.

If the technology used in TVs from two different brands is the same—for example, if both the brands are using active-shutter technology—the 3-D glasses can be used interchangeably.

Content for 3-D TVs

There are two ways to watch 3-D content on your 3-D TV.

Some 3-D TVs have a 2-D/3-D converter built into them that allows 2-D content to be translated into 3-D. There is some software available that helps rewrite 2-D content into 3-D format, even close to real-time speeds (such as TV telecast speeds). However, such algorithms are only an approximation, and usually cannot match the real capturing of the content from two



Videocon Satellite LCD TV

different angles.

True 3-D content is filmed in 3-D especially for the 3-D TV experience. The content has two sets of images—one meant for the left eye and the other set for the right eye. Such content is normally generated by shooting the same event with multiple cameras, and superimposing the two images in a certain way. You need a Blu-ray player and HDMI cables to be able to enjoy a good 3-D experience on TV.

There are many movies (like *Avatar* and *Resident Evil*) and video games already available that have been created just for 3-D. Plans for 3-D TV channels are also under way.

Sony is involved at every stage of the 3-D value chain and draws on its expertise in professional solutions, consumer electronics, movie making and gaming alike.

Advice to consumers

Currently, 3-D technology is expensive and content availability is limited. Glasses, 3-D gear, and of course, the TVs themselves command a premium price. Therefore it will be a niche high-

end proposition for the immediate future.

However, like any technology, 3-D TV technology is expected to improve quickly—although glasses-free 3-D is still a few years away. It is expected to address all the issues related to eyestrain and headache. Also you will find more and more content filmed in 3-D. For instance, Sony Pictures will soon be releasing the most awaited movies in the world in 3-D, such as *Underworld 4*, *Men in Black 3* and *Spider-Man 4*.

At the moment, for those on a limited budget, getting a new, non-3-D TV now is still a fairly safe bet, and you can be sure to enjoy it even after 3-D becomes more common.

Between LCD and LED TVs, it's better to go for an LCD TV (unless you must have the latest) because of its value for money. You would certainly not want to pay almost double the LCD price just for the slimmer design of an LED TV, if ultimately you are going to mount the TV on a wall. ●

The author is a deputy editor at EFM



Godrej Game LCD TV